



Favourites: The Women in Blue boast a strong record against the island nation, having won 20 of their 26 encounters so far.

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The template for preview writers remains unchanged: how much can Athapaththu do alone?

Towards that end, Sri Lanka will field a new-look outfit for the India tour. Anushka Sanjeevani, Udesika Prabodhani, Achini Kulasuriya, and Sugandika Kumar have been left out, making way for fresh faces eager to make an impression at the international level.

Among the inclusions are 17-year-old ambidextrous spinner Shashini Gimhani, returning to the national side for the first time since August 2024, and left-arm spinner Nimesha Madushani, who has earned her maiden call-up. Kaushini Nuthyangana is likely to step in for Anushka behind the stumps.

At the ODI World Cup, players such as Harshitha Samarawickrama and Vishmi Gunaratne were tested extensively. They showed signs of handling the pressure but fell just short of translating promise into wins. Sri Lanka will hope that the belief and momentum these youngsters generated during the Asia Cup

triumph carry through against a formidable opponent in an important year.

Power of stability

India's ODI World Cup-winning squad largely features in this series. Pratika Rawal, who was never part of the T20 scheme of things to begin with, is missing, while the other two names, leg-spinner Radha Yadav and back-up keeper Uma Chetry, have made way for two fresh faces in left-arm spinner Vaishnavi Sharma and keeper-batter G. Kamalini.

Vaishnavi was the leading wicket-taker with 17 wickets at this year's Under-19 Women's World Cup. The 19-year-old has also been in good touch on the domestic circuit, picking up 21 wickets in the Senior Women's T20 Trophy and 12 scalps from five matches, the most, in the Senior Women's Inter-Zonal T20s.

Kamalini, who also impressed at the Under-19 Women's World Cup as the third-highest run-scorer with 143 runs, finds a place in the squad as the backup wicketkeeper to Richa Ghosh. The Tamil Nadu and Mumbai Indians

player comes into the tournament on the back of a strong run in the Senior Women's T20 Trophy, where she scored 297 runs in seven matches. This effectively shuts the door on Uma, who also went without takers in the Women's Premier League auction.

Muzumdar's penchant for experimentation is not lost on anyone, and India has three solid opportunities, along with the fertile ground of the WPL, to fine-tune its eleven ahead of the showpiece in England.



India's squad: Harmanpreet Kaur (C), Smriti Mandhana (VC), Deepti Sharma, Sneha Rana, Jemimah Rodrigues, Shafali Verma, Harleen Deol, Amanjot Kaur, Arundhati Reddy, Kranti Gaud, Renuka Singh Thakur, Richa Ghosh (WK), G. Kamalini (WK), Sree Charani, Vaishnavi Sharma.

Sri Lanka's squad: Chamari Athapaththu (C), Harshitha Samarawickrama (VC), Hasini Perera, Vishmi Gunaratne, Nilakshika De Silva, Kavisha Dilhari, Imesha Dulani, Kaushini Nuthyangana, Malsha Shehani, Inoka Ranaweera, Shashini Gimhani, Nimesha Madushani, Kawya Kavindi, Rashmika Sewwandi, Malki Madara.